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Lead Cyber Detect and Respond Analyst (Ref: 20811)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 27th August 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

476307

Salary

£42,914 - £53,081

The national salary is £42,914 - £46,182. London salary is £49,325 - £53,081. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

MOJ Grade SEO

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

Lead Cyber Detect and Respond Analyst

Location: National*

Closing Date: 27th August 2026

Interviews: w/c 7th September 2026

Grade: SEO (MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary:** **National:** £42,914 - £51,675 which may include an allowance up to £8,761. **London:** £49,325 - £56,050 which may include an allowance up to £6,725.

Working pattern: Full-time, Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 2

Vacancy number: 20811

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We're recruiting for a Lead Cyber Detect and Respond Analyst here at Justice Digital, Data and Science to be part of our warm and collaborative Digital Infrastructure and Security Operations (DISO) team.

This role aligns against Monitoring Lead from the Government Security Profession Framework.

The Lead Cyber Detect and Respond Analyst will lead the proactive monitoring, analysis, and response to security events and incidents, ensuring the effective detection and mitigation of cyber threats to the Ministry of Justice (MoJ). The lead analyst develops and refines detection and response procedures, mentors junior team members, and provides expert guidance during high-severity incidents.

Operating with a high degree of independence and technical authority, this role plays a critical part in strengthening the MoJ's cyber resilience and advancing the maturity of SOC operations.

We recognise that people develop skills through a variety of professional, academic, and lived experiences.

Key Responsibilities:

SOC actively monitor the hours between 8am - 6pm and provide on call coverage if needed outside of these hours. This is managed on a rota basis. Additional allowances are provided for on-call staff.

Lead the day-to-day coordination of security operations activities, ensuring investigations, incident response actions, and operational tasks are effectively assigned, tracked, and delivered.

Manage operational workload distribution across the team, balancing priorities, resolving resource conflicts, and maintaining visibility of deadlines and service commitments.

Oversee and maintain incident and investigation tracking processes, ensuring records are accurate, up to date, and provide clear operational oversight.

Act as one of the primary escalation points for complex security investigations, incidents, and operational issues, providing direction and support to analysts.

Mentor and coach analysts in investigative techniques, incident handling, and response processes to improve team capability and consistency.

Line Management/People Management responsibilities, requiring a strong people person who can build trusted relationships, motivate and support individuals, manage performance constructively, communicate effectively at all levels, and create a positive and collaborative team environment.

Benefits.

You will receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work-life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer here. To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please take a look at our blog.

Person Specification

Essential

Experience working in a Security Operations Centre (SOC) or similar cyber security role.

Previous experience leading, coordinating, or supervising.

Working understanding of cybersecurity operations, threat detection methodologies, and incident response processes.

Strong experience in analysing and correlating logs (e.g., SIEM, XDR/EDR, cloud, network).

Excellent analytical and critical thinking skills, with the ability to make sound decisions under pressure.

Strong communication skills, capable of presenting findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Strong people skills with experience mentoring and developing junior analysts, building confidence and capability within the team while contributing to SOC process and detection improvements.

Demonstrated ability to work collaboratively across teams and with external partners.

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for SC clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Justice Digital, Data and Science (Ministry of Justice) was named **Best Employer of the Year** at the Women in Tech Excellence Awards 2025.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from **London:** £49,325 - £53,081: **National:** £42,914 - £46,182

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £6,725 per year (London) or £8,761 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

AnchorHow to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Success Profiles** and Government Security Profession Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application (please amend accordingly):

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work

undertaken. It should specifically address the following 5 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Experience working in a Security Operations Centre (SOC) or similar cyber security role.

Previous experience leading, coordinating, or supervising.

Working understanding of cybersecurity operations, threat detection methodologies, and incident response processes.

Excellent analytical and critical thinking skills, with the ability to make sound decisions under pressure.

Strong communication skills, capable of presenting findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on the following criteria will be conducted before the sift:

Experience working in a Security Operations Centre (SOC) or similar cyber security role.

Working understanding of cybersecurity operations, threat detection methodologies, and incident response processes.

Excellent analytical and critical thinking skills, with the ability to make sound decisions under pressure.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be

assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

Leadership

Making effective decisions

Delivering at pace

Developing Self and Others

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the delivering at pace behaviour will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our [Terms and Conditions](#) which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to the attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £42,914, Ministry of Justice contributes £12,432 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

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Selection process details

How to Apply

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Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?JobId=1166>



